

1. The Golden Touch



gratitude, responsibility

Warm-up

Make a list of four things you own and value the most. Tell your class why these things are important to you.



COM

CT

This story about King Midas is a myth from Greece. A myth is a traditional story that has been handed down from one generation to the next. Myths usually have a lot of magic and excitement.

2nd

IL

Once upon a time, there was a king called Midas. He was rich, very rich, and he was fond of collecting gold.



Though he loved gold a lot, there was one thing in the world he loved more. It was his lovely little daughter.





King Midas kept all his gold in a dark room in his palace. He would go down to this dark room and spend hours just looking at all the gold he had collected.



He never knew the value of his collection, because he never counted the number of **ingots** he had. He loved to sit down and just look at all his gold. He should have been a happy man, but he was not. He always wanted more.



One day, sitting in the dark room, watching over his gold, he saw a stranger appearing out of the shadows.

Midas, you must be a happy man. You have a lot of gold.



Midas did not stop to think who the stranger was.

No, I am not happy. I do not have enough gold. I want more.



ingots

blocks of gold or silver



How much gold do you need to be happy?

I wish that everything I touch would turn into gold.



Are you sure you want your wish to come true?

Yes, I would be very happy if I had the 'golden touch'.



The stranger granted him the 'golden touch' and disappeared.

So be it!



The next morning, when the sunbeams entered Midas' room, he woke up.





He started to touch things within his reach, and as soon as he did, they turned into gold. The bunch of roses in a vase, the curtains, the bedsheet and his clothes all turned to gold.



He ran down to the garden, which was full of blooming roses. Every flower he touched turned into gold.



Satisfied at having found so much gold, King Midas went for breakfast. Alas! The food and drink he touched turned to solid gold.



The worst was still to come. His little daughter who rushed into his arms also turned into a golden statue. Now Midas was in great sorrow and despair.



despair

sadness





How I wish I was the poorest man on earth! If only I could get my daughter back!



Suddenly, the stranger who had given him the 'golden touch' appeared before him.

Are you happy, dear Midas, now that you can turn everything into gold?



I have never been more miserable in my life! I have lost what I truly love. Now I know that gold is not everything. Take back my 'golden touch', I beg of you, and give my daughter back to me!



The stranger took pity on the king.

Bring some water from the river that flows near your palace. Sprinkle that water over everything.



miserable

unhappy

sprinkle

spray a few drops on something





Midas rushed to fill a jug with the river water. Soon the jug and the king's outfit started getting back to their original state.



He then poured some water over his daughter's statue. Immediately, his little daughter smiled and hugged him.



Then, he ran around the garden and the palace. He kept on pouring water to bring everything back to the original form.



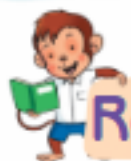
After this, King Midas went on to become a wise and noble king. He had learnt that gold was not the most precious thing in the world.



original

in the earlier form; being the way it always used to be





Reading

(reading for main ideas)



A. Tick (✓) the right options to complete these sentences.

Solve this exercise in pairs. Then share your answers with another group. Check each other's answers.    **TC**

- King Midas was a very rich man because he had
 - many friends.
 - good health.
 - an intelligent mind.
 - lots of gold.
- More than gold, King Midas loved his
 - palace.
 - room.
 - daughter.
 - clothes.
- Every day, King Midas would
 - go for a walk.
 - look at his gold.
 - read to his daughter.
 - meet the people of his kingdom.
- King Midas was not a very happy man because
 - he was bored.
 - he wanted more gold.
 - he had no real friend.
 - he wanted to conquer more kingdoms.
- The gold was kept
 - in a safe.
 - in a dark room in the king's palace.
 - in a shed.
 - in the king's cupboard.

B. Answer these questions and check your answers. 

- Who appeared in the dark room one day?
- What did he ask King Midas?
- Why did the king say he was unhappy?
- What was the king's wish?
- What did the stranger grant the king?



C. Think and answer.   **CT**

(reading for inference; HOTS)

- Why was King Midas unhappy at the start of the story?
- Was there a change in King Midas by the end of the story?
Give reasons for your answer.



D. Discuss in class. **CT**

(value-based question)

Look at the list you made at the beginning of this chapter. Now think about the things which bring joy in your life. Create a new list. Compare the two lists.



Using Grammar

(common nouns)

You have already learnt that the name of a person or thing is called a **noun**. For example, you write with a **pencil**, and that is its name. You comb your hair with a **comb** or **hairbrush**, and those are its names. Such names are called **common nouns**. They are general or common names. Some other examples are **boy**, **girl**, **cat** and **spider**.

- A. Work in groups of four and underline the common nouns in these sentences. Then pass your answers to the next group. Each group should check the answers they have got.**  

1. The king lived in a big palace.
2. His garden was full of blooming flowers.
3. A stranger appeared in his room suddenly.
4. The curtains, his bedsheet and his clothes all turned into gold.
5. He had to sprinkle water to get everything back to its original form.



(proper nouns)

When we say, “**Anita**, use the blue pencil”, or “**Anita**, use a comb to untangle your hair”, then we are using a special or specific name—**Anita**. This is called a **proper noun**.

A proper noun can be the name of a person, a country, such as, **India**, your school or your pet. A proper noun always begins with a capital letter.

- B. Create your own proper nouns in these sentences. Check your answers with your teacher.** 

1. The palace that King **Midas** lived in was called **Shinyvale**.
2. His daughter's name was _____.

3. He lived in the city of _____.
4. The river from which water was brought was called _____.
5. The stranger's name was _____.



(collective nouns)

A **collective noun** is a word that describes a collection or a group of people, animals or things.

- Every day, a **bunch** of roses was placed at the king's table.
- A **swarm** of bees surrounded the sweet-smelling flowers.



C. Complete these sentences with the right words from the box.



herd flock pile circle clump army

1. The _____ of soldiers marched past the palace.
2. A _____ of unwashed bedsheets lay in the dark room.
3. Every day, a _____ of birds visited the royal garden.
4. The king's daughter had a large _____ of friends.
5. The river was surrounded by a _____ of trees.
6. A _____ of cattle grazed in the field.



D. Work in pairs and unscramble the words to get the collective nouns.

1. a ORHAD of gold



2. a TERTLI of puppies



3. a ACPK of cards



4. a ROCWD of people





Using Words

(synonyms)

A word that means the same as another is called a **synonym**.

sad – miserable, unhappy

- A. Underline the right synonyms from the brackets for the highlighted words given in the sentences. Work in pairs and check your partner's answers. Then find out a few more synonyms of the words highlighted in bold.**



- King Midas was **delighted** (happy/angry) when his daughter came back to life.
- King Midas was very **rich** (fat/wealthy).
- King Midas finally became a **wise** (silly/sensible) king.
- King Midas also learnt that gold is not the most **precious** (valuable/worthless) thing in the world.
- Satisfied** (Happy/Angry) at having so much gold, King Midas went for breakfast.
- The stranger granted him the 'golden touch' and **disappeared** (entered/vanished).

(antonyms)

A word that means the opposite of another word is called an **antonym**.

- tall – short
- rich – poor

- B. Match the words in column A with their opposites in column B.**

Discuss your answers with your teacher.



A

- bright
- difficult
- quiet
- tidy
- wide

B

- easy
- dull
- narrow
- noisy
- untidy





Spelling

(familiar words)

Work in pairs. Your partner should read out the words one by one and you should spell them out without looking at the words. Take turns to spell out the words and correct your partner if she/he misspells.

collect

daughter

palace

value

ingots

stranger

appeared

thought

enough

touch



Assessment of Speaking and Listening



Listening

(connecting aural and visual information)

Look at this picture and listen to the audio to complete this passage. Play the audio again and check your answers.



The palace is _____ and is made of _____. A _____ silk _____ flies on the _____ tower. Beautiful _____ surround the palace. Behind the palace is a _____ and, beyond that, _____ mountains rise.

Pronunciation

(recognition of odd vowel sound)

Each set of words has one word with a different vowel sound. Say them aloud correctly with the help of your teacher and identify the odd words. Check the correct pronunciations with your teacher.

spring

pink

think

feel

mock

small

shop

log

start

fun

mask

grasp

wet

chat

match

ash

true

shoot

put

food

pearl

girl

teacher

birth



Speaking

(making a request)

If you were King Midas, how would you ask the stranger for the 'golden touch'?

Whenever we want to make a request we use words like **Can I**, **Could I**, **May I** or **Please**.

Work in pairs. Role play these situations to express a request.

1. You want to seek permission from your class teacher to go home early from school.
2. You want to go to your friend's house to play and need to ask your parents for permission.
3. You want to borrow a book from your friend and need to ask him/her about it.



Writing

(sequencing a story)

This is the story of King Midas but the sentences are not in the right order.

Rearrange and write the correct numbers beside the sentences.



- Now, the king was happy because everything he touched turned to gold. ☐
- One day, a stranger came to his room and asked him the reason for his sorrow. ☐
- King Midas was an unhappy king who wanted more and more gold. ☐
- So, the stranger granted him the 'golden touch'. ☐
- The king told him that he was sad because he wanted more gold. ☐
- King Midas was never unhappy again for he had learnt his lesson. ☐
- But he became miserable when his daughter too turned into gold. ☐
- At last, everything became normal again. ☐
- Midas then asked the stranger to take back his wish. ☐



Punctuation

(the comma)

A **comma** is a punctuation mark. It tells us when to pause, especially when we are reading, though it is a short pause.

The bunch of roses in a vase, the curtains, the bedsheet and his clothes all turned to gold.

We separate items with commas when we list them in a sentence. Notice that there is no comma before **and**. Try reading this sentence without the commas and you will understand the difference.

Place commas in these sentences. Check your answers with your teacher. 

1. There were rubies sapphires emeralds diamonds and gold in the boxes.
2. Visitors courtiers ambassadors and common people could be found in the king's court.
3. The king's garden was full of roses lilies tulips and pansies.
4. Sparrows nightingales robins and larks visited the garden every day.
5. The king turned his daughter the curtains the bedsheet his clothes and the flowers back to their original forms.



Life Skills Activity

(critical thinking)

The Golden Touch is an ancient Greek myth. There is also a lesson in it for us to learn from.

A. Fill in the blank to find out the moral of this story. Choose the right word from the box.  

happy greedy rich

Do not be _____.

B. Think of an interesting Indian myth. You may ask your parents to help you look up a book of stories. Tell the story to your class.    

